

get back on to the WhatsAppinar and catch up on existing questions and answers that other participants on the group may have enquired about,” informs Ganguly.

The company invites prospective clients to the WhatsAppinar by email. Once registered, users get a link to join the WhatsAppinar 24 hours prior to the WhatsAppinar, following which the sessions begin. Once the sessions are over, users can post their queries or suggestions.

Freeze of Aspect Software, however, notes that for brands to use WhatsApp effectively, they need to integrate it efficiently with their other channels. “Adding a service channel that consumers use and trust makes sense to increase engagement and provide service on the terms of your customers. But if that channel is not fully integrated with access to customer data, reporting resources and the expertise of the contact centre, it will hardly deliver an optimal experience. By applying contact centre best practices to mobile customer engagements, organisations can realise better value from the channel at a lower cost, without sacrificing the disciplines and service levels that are making the contact centre the *de facto* centre of the customer experience.”

Internal communication

Considering the privacy that WhatsApp offers, most enterprises often use it for internal communications. Be it discussing a project to implementing employee engagement initiative, WhatsApp serves as a perfect platform to communicate. For instance, companies such as insurance web aggregator Policy Bazaar use WhatsApp for internal communications. The company has separate WhatsApp groups of each business unit as well as the management, wherein important information and updates are shared with everyone.

“For us, it looked like the perfect tool to keep everyone in the loop and help managers reach their team members at any moment of their workday. It is also a good way to maintain these employees’ engagement to their company by offering them the same information as the ones who can access the corporate website or intranet,” says Alexandra Guimaraes, an HR expert in her blog “Should you use WhatsApp for your internal communications?”

It is interesting to note that while WhatsApp is great tool for companies to do their business efficiently, unfortunately it has not yet been explored much by India Inc. However, once they realise the value of this simple instant messenger, WhatsApp could be the next big thing in the communication space in the country. **EFY**

—Parba Das

360-Degree Videos To Lower Costs

► Use of 360-degree videos for corporate training is best suited to large-scale enterprises that often organise training sessions for their employees across the country or overseas

Enterprises are often scouting for the next best technology for their businesses. After all, managers want their companies to become profitable—be it by cost-cutting or implementing systems

that help them connect with their customers better.

That’s exactly what the creative agency behind Flipkart’s Treasure Hunt campaign had on its mind. To promote Flipkart’s annual *Big Billion Day* sale, Dentsu Webcutney, the creative agency that executed the campaign, used a 360-degree technology to give customers a tour of Flipkart’s head office in Bengaluru where customers had to hunt and earn their treasures, to get discounts on the products listed on the website.

“For us, engaging with our users with a compelling story is as important as sales. We constantly like to push the frontiers—be it with our service, technology or consumer engagements,” Shoumyan Biswas, vice president-marketing at Flipkart, had said some time back.

This is just one example where 360-degree cameras have been used to get some exceptional response. We explore here other benefits from using this technology.

Lower your surveillance cost

The most important application of 360-degree cameras is security and surveillance. Nowadays, most companies install surveillance cameras to ensure safety and security of their assets. And the need for upping the security will only grow more.

Small-scale enterprises need to spend at least ₹ 100,000, while medium-scale or large enterprises spend ₹ 1 million to ₹ 1.5 million on the entire surveillance solution for their office premises. Usually, cameras installed are the traditional pan-tilt-zoom (PTZ) type that have a narrow field of view and require additional components to monitor an entire area, which makes them more susceptible to mechanical failures. Also, these cameras have a higher chance of missing out a critical activity as they cannot capture an all-round